

Digi-Key signs distribution partnership with Rigol Technologies

Global electronic components distributor Digi-Key Electronics has expanded its product portfolio by signing a North American distribution partnership with Rigol Technologies. It is a part of Digi-Key's Marketplace initiative to broaden the product offering to customers. Rigol Technologies deals in digital oscilloscopes, waveform generators, multimeters and DC loads. Its product range also includes digital and mixed-signal oscilloscopes, spectrum analysers and RF signal generators, arbitrary waveform generators, sensitive measurement products, and data acquisition systems. Recently, Digi-Key Electronics had announced that it was offering a free eBook on the benefits of implementing Application Programming Interface (API) solutions, as well as a new ROI calculator to see the return on investment that implementing APIs can deliver.

Keysight launches Innovate Anywhere program

Keysight Technologies has launched the 'Innovate Anywhere' program in response to Covid-19. This program spans across three key areas including 90-day software trials, remote learning, and scalable live network testing. Keysight is offering the company's popular software products free of charge for 90 days. Engineers working on design and simulation or managing multiple instruments and test stations remotely, can leverage Keysight's PC-based soft-

ware to remain productive. These 90-day software trials also provide complimentary access to KeysightCare Software Support for the duration of the trials featuring live interaction with a technical expert within four hours of contacting Keysight.

STMicroelectronics launches Smart Gateway Platform

The Smart Gateway Platform (SGP) from STMicroelectronics provides a valuable development tool for prototyping automotive Smart-Gateway and Domain-Controller applications. ST's modular Smart-Gateway Platform (SGP), built on gigabit Ethernet communication between the secure and ASIL-B Telemaco3P microprocessor (MPU) and the ASIL-D SPC58/Chorus microcontroller (MCU), delivers powerful processing capability to handle firewall functionalities, predictive maintenance, over-the-air (OTA) upgrades, and high data-rate communication among different ECUs and to the cloud. The SGP reference design features a rich set of in-vehicle network interfaces including multiple Ethernet and CAN ports as well as support for LIN and FlexRay connections.

It is deployed with a comprehensive starter package including hardware design files, hardware/software documentation, software utilities (drivers and flashers), and sample applications. The SGP also integrates expansion connections to Wi-Fi and LTE modules for full prototyping of use cases requiring cloud-connectivity simulation.

Incentives for electronic components and semiconductors manufacture

In a bid to improve and strengthen the indigenous manufacturing of electronic components and semiconductors in the country, the government of India has approved a scheme for the promotion of this sector. The total cost of the scheme is approximately ₹ 32.85 billion, which includes incentive outlay of approximately ₹ 32.52 billion and administrative expense to the tune of ₹ 0.32 billion.

"We are confident that the government's assurance of providing a financial incentive of 25 per cent on capital expenditure for the identified list of electronic goods and components, will not only enable India to become the electronics manufacturing hub of the world but also provide a fillip to its 'Make in India' program. All of these steps are going to provide a much-needed boost to the sector and help homegrown companies like Goldmedal Electricals expand their business capabilities further," says Kishan Jain, director at Goldmedal Electricals.

As per industry estimates, electronics manufacturing has generated employment for over two mil-

lion people across the country. This scheme, as the government informed, will be open for applications initially for three years from the date of its notification. The incentives will be available for investments made within five years from the date of acknowledgment of application.

Opportune time for India as companies shift base from China

The Ministry of New and Renewable Energy (MNRE) has initiated action in a big way towards setting up new hubs for manufacturing renewable energy equipment in the country to meet both domestic and global demand. With this objective in view, the ministry has written to various state governments and various port authorities to identify land parcels of fifty to five hundred acres for setting up such parks.

Tuticorin Port Trust, Madhya Pradesh, and Odisha have already expressed their keen interest in setting up renewable energy manufacturing parks. These hubs, once set up, will manufacture equipment like silicon ingots and wafers, solar cells and modules, wind equipment and ancillary items like back sheets, glass, steel frames, inverters, batteries, etc.

At present, the country has around 10GW of wind equipment manufacturing capacity.

"It may be stated that in a time when many companies are planning to shift their manufacturing base from China, it is opportune time for India to bring policy changes for facilitating and catalysing manufacturing in India. In tune with this, MNRE has set up the RE Industry Facilitation & Promotion Board to facilitate investment in RE sector," reads MNRE's official statement.

Automotive lithium-ion battery market to reach \$74.3 billion by 2024

It is expected that the global automotive lithium-ion battery will generate revenue of 74.3 billion dollars in 2024, advancing at a 15.9 per cent CAGR during the forecast period of 2019-2024, as per a recent P&S Intelligence report. It further says that in 2018 the global automotive lithium-ion battery market generated 24.2 billion dollars.

The report adds that different types of vehicles make use of lithium-ion batteries. These include two-wheelers, commercial vehicles, and passenger cars. In 2018, the largest demand for